

1. User Group Profile

Target users: Active-duty service members & U.S. veterans enrolled in undergraduate programs (community colleges & 4-year institutions). Often older than traditional college students; many are part-time, juggling family, work, and service obligations; familiar with technology.

Demographics & scale

- Veterans $\approx$ 6% of the U.S. undergraduate student population.
- ~573,700 Post-9/11 GI Bill beneficiaries (FY2024).

Pain points

- Loss of credit when transferring institutions.
- Complexity of VA / GI Bill eligibility, Yellow Ribbon, cost comparisons.
- Limited veteran-friendly campus support and community.
- Life/schedule disruptions (deployments, orders, family) making flexibility essential.

Habits & preferences

- Use mobile & web for administrative tasks, benefits, enrollment.
 - Use institutional tools (Registrar, Veteran Affairs Office), benefit comparison tools, transfer equivalency resources.
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2. Market Size & Opportunity

Population base:

- GI Bill eligible / beneficiary pool: ~573,700.
- Veteran undergraduate student presence ~6%.

Opportunity opportunities:

- Tools that reduce credit loss during transfer or institution changes.
 - Consolidation of benefit & cost comparison, Yellow Ribbon info, VA-based guidance.
 - Flexible degree planning that handles pauses, relocations, deployments.
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3. Competitor Analysis

Competitor	Key Features	Strengths	Gaps & Weaknesses
VA: GI Bill Comparison Tool	Compare approved schools, Yellow Ribbon participation, cost estimators	Authoritative, up-to-date, trusted	No credit equivalency/transcript transfer feature; limited personalized planning; not deployment-aware
eBenefits / VA Mobile	Administrative tasks: benefits status, document uploads, claims	Secure, centralized for benefits management	Not focused on transfer credit, degree mapping, or personalized academic planning
Transferology / CollegeSource	Transfer equivalency lookup, including military learning, institutional participation	Mature database, well-used in many colleges	Doesn't integrate VA benefit complexity; degree planning not built for veteran-specific disruption; expects user-side understanding of transfer

Competitive gaps & white space

- No single tool combining VA benefit rules + transfer equivalency + deployment-aware degree mapping.

- Need for personalized path-planning with proactive credit preservation and contingency workflows.

4. Unique Value Proposition (UVP)

“One app to preserve progress” — A platform that **translates military training**, compares benefit-eligibility, assists with cost & Yellow Ribbon, and creates degree plans that adapt to relocations or deployments.

Differentiators

- Integrated data: VA benefit info + transfer equivalency APIs.
- Deployment-aware workflows: ability to pause/resume, preserve benefits/credits.
- Action-oriented support: checklists, transcript/syllabus request helpers, institutional guidance.

5. Visualization

Estimated Share of U.S. Undergraduate Students Who Are Military Veterans (Estimate)

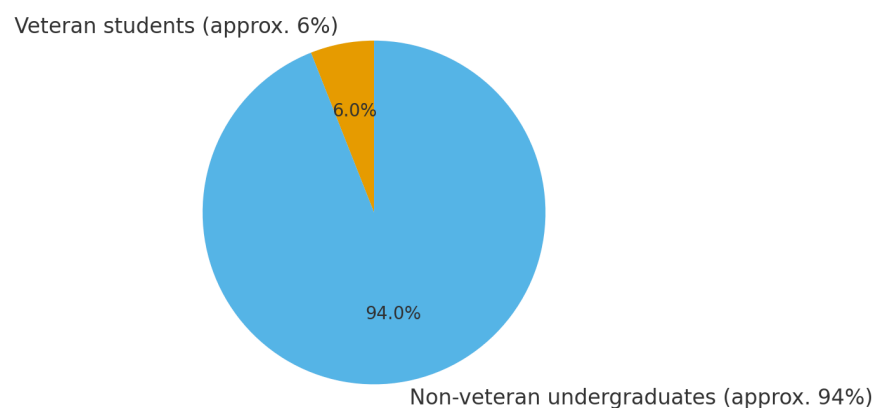


Figure 1. Estimated share of undergraduates who are military veterans (~6%) vs non-veterans (~94%).

Relevance: Shows that while veterans represent a minority, their numbers are large enough to justify targeted tools and services. Helps frame the size of the addressable market.

(Data source: national higher education statistics summaries, GI Bill / VA education reports.)

6. AI Use & Verification

Tools used

- ChatGPT (drafting, synthesizing, comparing)
- Web searches via official reports (VA, SVA, Ithaka S+R, Transferology)
- Python (for visualization/chart)

Sample prompts

- “List recent statistics on undergraduate veteran enrollment in the U.S., with authoritative sources.”
- “Compare features of VA GI Bill tool, Transferology, and eBenefits in terms of degree planning for veterans.”
- “What are top pain points for student veterans in undergraduate programs?”

Fact-checking / verification

- Always cross-checked statistics with primary sources (VA education reports, peer-reviewed studies).
- Distinguished between estimates vs exact counts.
- Used domain-authority sources; avoided relying solely on generic blogs.

References

- U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs. *FY2024 Education Beneficiary Reports*.
- Student Veterans of America, Annual Census & Surveys.
- Ithaka S+R reports on veteran enrollment, transfer, and student veteran experiences.
- Transferology / CollegeSource documentation.
- VETWAYS Phase 1 report on Veteran Students in U.S. Institutions.